Over 2.5 goals: V4 report

Tue 03 Nov 2026 to Thu 05 Nov 2026 (english). All times UK.

Executive summary

18 fixtures analysed: High 1, Medium 2, Weak 0, rejected 15. Selected fixtures with both attacks scoring 2+ in 3 of 5 or better: 1.

Selection engine: the validated model (V4 lock; V4.1 changes in config/model_config.json). Benchmark, season 2026-27 to 2026-11-01 (1700 finished fixtures, Rob's 14 leagues, clean out of sample): 3+ goals in High 74 of 105, Medium 132 of 219, trump card 3 of 3, rejected 766 of 1373. Band counts, not the chance of any one fixture. Scored 2+ and Let in 2+ counts are shown on every card as supporting evidence; both attacks at 3 of 5+ adds about three points inside the bands and is highlighted, not required.

Selected fixtures ranked by model score (up to 20)

#	Kick-off (UK)	Competition	Fixture	Home sc2+ / let2+	Away sc2+ / let2+	Both 3/5+	BTTS	Confidence	Division	Main risk (Over 2.5 = Yes for every row)
1	Tue 03 Nov 19:45	League One	Huddersfield v Luton	5/5 · 1/5	4/5 · 1/5	yes	YES (Med)	High	cold	Home side kept 2/5 clean sheets
2	Tue 03 Nov 20:00	Championship	Birmingham v Millwall	3/5 · 0/5	2/5 · 2/5		NO (Med)	Medium	warm	Home side kept 3/5 clean sheets
3	Tue 03 Nov 19:45	National League South	Dorking Wanderers v Hampton & Richmond	4/5 · 2/5	2/5 · 3/5		NO (Med)	Medium	cold	Away side failed to score in 3/5

Grouped shortlist (date, competition, confidence, model score)

Tue 03 Nov · Championship

Medium	Birmingham v Millwall 20:00	H scored 2+ 3/5 · H let in 2+ 0/5 · A scored 2+ 2/5 · A let in 2+ 2/5	BTTS NO (Medium)

Tue 03 Nov · League One

High	Huddersfield v Luton 19:45	H scored 2+ 5/5 · H let in 2+ 1/5 · A scored 2+ 4/5 · A let in 2+ 1/5 · both 3/5+	BTTS YES (Medium)

Tue 03 Nov · National League South

Medium	Dorking Wanderers v Hampton & Richmond 19:45	H scored 2+ 4/5 · H let in 2+ 2/5 · A scored 2+ 2/5 · A let in 2+ 3/5	BTTS NO (Medium)

Fixture cards

Championship

Birmingham v Millwall

Championship · Tue 03 Nov 20:00 UK

OVER 2.5 YES · confidence MEDIUM

BTTS lean YES (model Medium) · drivers 7 of 20

Division: warm, 96 of 156 games had 3+

BIRMINGHAM home

oldest → newest

scores: 1-0, 4-0, 3-0, 0-1, 3-1

SCORED 2+		**3/5**
LET IN 2+		**0/5**
Game had 3+		3/5
Both scored		1/5
At home, 3+		4/5

MILLWALL away

oldest → newest

scores: 1-0, 0-1, 2-2, 1-2, 4-1

SCORED 2+		**2/5**
LET IN 2+		**2/5**
Game had 3+		3/5
Both scored		3/5
Away, 3+		4/5

HOME ATTACK → AWAY DEFENCE

Birmingham scored 2+: 3/5

Millwall let in 2+: 2/5

Route: Some support

Birmingham: clean sheets 3/5, failed to score 1/5, both scored 1/5

AWAY ATTACK → HOME DEFENCE

Millwall scored 2+: 2/5

Birmingham let in 2+: 0/5

Route: Weak

Millwall: clean sheets 1/5, failed to score 1/5, both scored 3/5

Why: Birmingham 3 of 5 games with 3+ and Millwall 3 of 5; both scored in 1 of 5 (Birmingham) and 3 of 5 (Millwall). Venue: Birmingham 4 of 5 home games with 3+, Millwall 4 of 5 away.

Risk: Home side kept 3/5 clean sheets

League One

Huddersfield v Luton

League One · Tue 03 Nov 19:45 UK

OVER 2.5 YES · confidence HIGH

BTTS YES (model Medium) · drivers 11 of 20 · TRUMP CARD

Division: cold, 83 of 155 games had 3+

both attacks 3 of 5+

HUDDERSFIELD home

oldest → newest

scores: 2-2, 2-0, 4-1, 2-1, 3-0

SCORED 2+		**5/5**
LET IN 2+		**1/5**
Game had 3+		4/5
Both scored		3/5
At home, 3+		4/5

LUTON away

oldest → newest

scores: 1-2, 2-1, 2-1, 3-1, 2-0

SCORED 2+		**4/5**
LET IN 2+		**1/5**
Game had 3+		4/5
Both scored		4/5
Away, 3+		4/5

HOME ATTACK → AWAY DEFENCE

Huddersfield scored 2+: 5/5

Luton let in 2+: 1/5

Route: Weak

Huddersfield: clean sheets 2/5, failed to score 0/5, both scored 3/5

AWAY ATTACK → HOME DEFENCE

Luton scored 2+: 4/5

Huddersfield let in 2+: 1/5

Route: Weak

Luton: clean sheets 1/5, failed to score 0/5, both scored 4/5

Why: Huddersfield 4 of 5 games with 3+ and Luton 4 of 5; both scored in 3 of 5 (Huddersfield) and 4 of 5 (Luton). Venue: Huddersfield 4 of 5 home games with 3+, Luton 4 of 5 away.

Risk: Home side kept 2/5 clean sheets

National League South

Dorking Wanderers v Hampton & Richmond

National League South · Tue 03 Nov 19:45 UK

OVER 2.5 YES · confidence MEDIUM

BTTS lean YES (model Medium) · drivers 11 of 20

Division: cold, 89 of 172 games had 3+

DORKING WANDERERS home

oldest → newest

scores: 4-3, 1-1, 3-1, 3-3, 2-0

SCORED 2+		**4/5**
LET IN 2+		**2/5**
Game had 3+		3/5
Both scored		4/5
At home, 3+		3/5

HAMPTON & RICHMOND away

oldest → newest

scores: 0-1, 0-2, 3-4, 2-2, 0-1

SCORED 2+		**2/5**
LET IN 2+		**3/5**
Game had 3+		2/5
Both scored		2/5
Away, 3+		2/5

HOME ATTACK → AWAY DEFENCE

Dorking Wanderers scored 2+: 4/5

Hampton & Richmond let in 2+: 3/5

Route: Strong

AWAY ATTACK → HOME DEFENCE

Hampton & Richmond scored 2+: 2/5

Dorking Wanderers let in 2+: 2/5

Route: Some support

Dorking Wanderers: clean sheets 1/5, failed to score 0/5, both scored 4/5

Hampton & Richmond: clean sheets 0/5, failed to score 3/5, both scored 2/5

Why: Dorking Wanderers 3 of 5 games with 3+ and Hampton & Richmond 2 of 5; both scored in 4 of 5 (Dorking Wanderers) and 2 of 5 (Hampton & Richmond). Venue: Dorking Wanderers 3 of 5 home games with 3+, Hampton & Richmond 2 of 5

Risk: Away side failed to score in 3/5

Rejected fixtures, with the model's reason

Kick-off (UK)	Competition	Fixture	H sc2+	H let2+	A sc2+	A let2+	Model	Reason
Tue 03 Nov 19:45	Championship	Blackburn v Stoke City	3/5	2/5	3/5	1/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 3/5 and 3/5
Tue 03 Nov 19:45	Championship	Charlton v Bolton	1/5	4/5	2/5	3/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 1/5 and 2/5
Tue 03 Nov 19:45	Championship	Derby v Norwich	0/5	2/5	2/5	2/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 0/5 and 2/5
Tue 03 Nov 19:45	Championship	Portsmouth v Swansea	2/5	1/5	2/5	1/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 2/5 and 2/5
Tue 03 Nov 19:45	Championship	Preston v Sheffield Utd	0/5	3/5	2/5	1/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 0/5 and 2/5
Tue 03 Nov 19:45	Championship	QPR v Burnley	2/5	2/5	2/5	3/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 2/5 and 2/5
Tue 03 Nov 19:45	Championship	Watford v Lincoln	2/5	3/5	2/5	4/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 2/5 and 2/5
Tue 03 Nov 20:00	Championship	West Brom v Southampton	3/5	1/5	2/5	1/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 3/5 and 2/5
Wed 04 Nov 19:45	Championship	Cardiff v West Ham	2/5	3/5	2/5	2/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 2/5 and 2/5
Wed 04 Nov 19:45	Championship	Wrexham v Middlesbrough	1/5	2/5	4/5	2/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 1/5 and 4/5
Wed 04 Nov 20:00	Championship	Bristol City v Wolves	1/5	1/5	2/5	1/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 1/5 and 2/5
Tue 03 Nov 19:45	League One	Wigan v Mansfield Town	1/5	4/5	3/5	1/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 1/5 and 3/5
Wed 04 Nov 19:45	League One	Oxford United v Reading	1/5	0/5	2/5	0/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 1/5 and 2/5
Tue 03 Nov 19:45	League Two	Northampton v Oldham	2/5	0/5	1/5	1/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 2/5 and 1/5
Tue 03 Nov 19:45	National League South	Farnborough v Ebbsfleet United	2/5	3/5	4/5	2/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 2/5 and 4/5

Data coverage and limitations

• Fixtures analysed: 18. Every count is taken from the stored final score of each match (fixture ID, teams, score); the five scorelines are printed on each card.

• Form sample: each side's last five completed league games this season, cup ties excluded; venue rows use the last five league games at that venue, sample size shown when fewer.

• Not covered by API Sports for 2026-27: Northern Premier, Isthmian and Southern League Division One. 'England V2' is not an API Sports competition and was not included.

• Scored first / conceded after leading: needs match event timelines, not pulled (one call per match, no history). Not shown. First-half goals: available from half-time scores, not yet on the card.

• Injuries and suspensions: the API returned lists for a minority of fixtures this week; nothing is inferred where it returned none. Squad rotation in cup ties is not assessed.

• Opposition strength: each side's opponents' scoring versus the division is held in the analysis file (oq columns) but is not part of the alignment score.

• Competitions in scope with no fixtures in the window: Premier League, National League, National League North.

Methodology (V4 lock)

• Selection: gradient-boosted model on each side's last-5 league counts (goals, 3+, 2+ scored, 2+ conceded, clean sheets, failed to score, BTTS), last-3 venue counts and the division's 3+ share. Trained on 2023-24 and 2024-25, validated on 2025-26; cut points from validation deciles. High = top decile; Medium = next two; Weak = bottom quarter of Medium; rejected below.

• Benchmark, season 2026-27 to 2026-11-01 (1700 finished fixtures, Rob's 14 leagues, clean out of sample): 3+ goals in High 74 of 105, Medium 132 of 219, trump card 3 of 3, rejected 766 of 1373. Band counts, not the chance of any one fixture.

• European cups (Champions, Europa and Conference League), measured separately, season 2026-27 (572 finished ties): 3+ goals in High 9 of 13, Medium 31 of 53, trump card 2 of 2, rejected 280 of 504. Cup ties are outside the 14-league benchmark; treat cup selections with that in mind.

• Scored 2+ and Let in 2+ are shown for both sides as evidence. Both attacks 3 of 5+ is highlighted (Selected with it 66%, High 71%) but never required: High fixtures failing a 2-of-5 attacking rule hit 73% on 222 fixtures.

• BTTS (V4.1): YES when the BTTS model is in its High band or the fixture is a trump card; lean YES for the Medium band; no lean for the Low band. BTTS model bands, same fixtures: High 105 of 168, Medium 750 of 1334, Low 119 of 198 had both teams score. A lean, not a pick, and never a veto on Over 2.5.

• V2 and V3 alignment scores were tested (62 to 66% at comparable sizes) and are not used for selection. Full tables in docs/backtest_baseline.md.

• No averages anywhere. Nothing inferred for missing data. Every count comes from stored final scores; the five scorelines are printed on each card.